



“DIGITALOCEAN IS BUILT ON A FOUNDATION OF OPEN SOURCE”

As open source is making things significantly better for developers, cloud service providers have started using the power of the open source community to grow their presence. DigitalOcean, a New York-headquartered company, founded in June 2011, is among the leading hosting companies worldwide and is one of the few cloud providers to have deployed open source-based technologies predominantly. In an exclusive conversation with Jagmeet Singh of OSFY, Prabhakar Jayakumar, country manager, DigitalOcean, highlights the key open source initiatives of the company. Edited excerpts:

Prabhakar Jayakumar,
country manager,
DigitalOcean

Q What does DigitalOcean have for developers around the globe?

DigitalOcean gives developers better software and tools to launch and scale any application in the cloud. By offering the simplest platform, the most transparent pricing and an elegant user interface, we reduce complexity so developers can build great software – faster.

Q From the available portfolio, what are the major open source-focused developments by DigitalOcean?

DigitalOcean is built on a foundation of open source. Whether you look at our hypervisors that are running kernel-based virtual machines (KVM) or our Rails apps running on our Kubernetes clusters, they are all open source-powered stacks. On top of that, our users are deploying open source based solutions to our platform every single day.

One of our core values as a company is that our community is bigger than us. We provide hosting credits to many open source projects, host several meetups in our office and even support them across the world. We are also members of organisations such as the Cloud Native Foundation and Ruby Together to help support the technologies we use.

Additionally, Hacktoberfest is a yearly initiative we produce in partnership with GitHub to generate excitement around contributing to open source in the month of October. The aim of this initiative is to inspire developers to contribute back to the projects they use. Last year, over 10,000 people completed the challenge opening up over 92,000 pull-requests to over 29,000 repos.

Q Do you feel it is difficult to support open source being a cloud service provider?

No, it is not difficult.